

Dr Chheang Vannarith

Visiting Senior Fellow ISEAS – Yusof Ishak Institute

Chairman, Advisory Council National Assembly of Cambodia

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Singapore and Cambodia

Cambodian public policy analyst, educator and regional affairs specialist with more than fifteen years of experience spanning government, academia, international development and policy research. His work focuses on Cambodia and Southeast Asia, particularly geopolitics, geoeconomics, ASEAN, major-power relations, leadership and innovation. A regular commentator for international media and author of five books and more than 60 research papers and policy analyses.

Cambodian foreign policy · ASEAN · Mekong subregion · China and Japan in Southeast Asia · Economic diplomacy · Public policy · Behavioural insights · Leadership and innovation

Current positions

Visiting Senior Fellow, ISEAS – Yusof Ishak Institute, Singapore

Lecturer in Public Policy and Global Affairs, Nanyang Technological University, Singapore

Chairman, Advisory Council of the National Assembly of Cambodia

Member, Supreme National Economic Council, Cambodia

Founding Chairman, Angkor Social Innovation Park

Previous positions

President, Asian Vision Institute, Phnom Penh

Lecturer in Asia-Pacific Studies, University of Leeds, United Kingdom — 2013–2016
Modules on international politics of the Asia-Pacific and governance and development in Southeast Asia

Executive Director, Cambodian Institute for Cooperation and Peace (CICP); later Adjunct Senior Fellow — 2009–2013

Co-founder and Chairman of the Advisory Board, Cambodian Institute for Strategic Studies

Technical Adviser, National Assembly of Cambodia, for the 32nd ASEAN Inter-Parliamentary Assembly — 2011

Assistant to the Minister of National Defence, Cambodia; supported the 6th ASEAN Defence Ministers' Meeting — 2011–2012

Visiting Scholar, China Institute of International Studies

Consultancy

Southeast Asia Consultant, The Nippon Foundation, Japan

International Consultant, UNDP; Oxfam; United Nations Capital Development Fund (UNCDF)

National Partnership Adviser, United Nations Office for Project Services (UNOPS)

Research Consultant, Asian Development Bank

Education

PhD, Asia Pacific Studies — 2009
Ritsumeikan Asia Pacific University, Japan

Leadership Certificate — 2008
East-West Center, Hawaii

MA, International Relations — 2006
International University of Japan

BA, International Relations — 2002
Diplomatic Academy of Vietnam

Executive programmes: Lee Kuan Yew School of Public Policy; University of Virginia; Stanford University.

Honours and fellowships

Young Global Leader — 2013
World Economic Forum

Global Emerging Voices — 2013
T-wai

Asian Public Intellectuals Fellowship — 2013–14
The Nippon Foundation

Southeast Asian Young Leader — 2016
IISS Shangri-La Dialogue

Books

- *Selected Works on Contemporary Perspective on Cambodia and the Asia-Pacific*, Vols. I–IV. CSSG (2014, with P. Kung), CISS (2017), Asian Vision Institute (2023), Cam Tech University (2025).
- *Tourism and Regional Integration in Southeast Asia.* Institute of Developing Economies (IDE-JETRO), Tokyo, 2013.

Selected articles and policy papers

- "Hun Manet's Worldview: An Exploratory Study." *Southeast Asian Affairs* 2025.
- "Strong Party-to-Party Relations Cement Cambodia–China Bilateral Ties." *ISEAS Perspective* 2023.
- "Cambodia–China Free Trade Agreement: A Cambodian Perspective." *ISEAS Perspective* 2023.
- "Cambodia's Multifaceted Foreign Policy and Agency in the Making." *The Pacific Review* 35(2) 2022.
- "International Relations as a Discipline in Cambodia: Still Nascent but Developing." *Contemporary Southeast Asia* 44(2) 2022.
- "Are Cambodia–U.S. Relations Mendable?" *Asia Policy* 2021.
- "Cambodia's Embrace of China's Belt and Road Initiative: Managing Asymmetries and Maximising Authority." *Asian Perspective* 2021.

Recent commentary

- "How Cambodia Can Maintain Strategic Trust with China." *China-Global South Project* September 2026.
- "Cambodia and Thailand Must Define the Border to Achieve Lasting Peace." *South China Morning Post* August 2026.
- "Cambodia's Three-Track Strategy for Peace with Thailand." *Fulcrum* July 2026.
- "Cambodia's War on Scammers Needs a Blueprint Built to Last." *South China Morning Post* July 2026.
- "Is the ASEAN–Japan Relationship Fit for the Times?" *East Asia Forum* September 2023.

Also published in Al Jazeera, Khmer Times, Eurasia Review and Stimson Center commentary.

Media

- Panel guest, *Inside Story*, Al Jazeera: "Can diplomacy end the conflict between Thailand and Cambodia?" December 2025.
- Quoted by Voice of America, Radio Free Asia, Mongabay and other international outlets on Cambodian politics, foreign policy and ASEAN.

Languages

Khmer (native), English (fluent), Vietnamese (fluent); basic French and Japanese

Speaking and advisory

Keynotes, panels and moderated dialogues on ASEAN, regional geopolitics, governance and development; executive workshops on public policy and leadership; and policy and political-risk briefings for organisations operating in Cambodia and ASEAN. All engagements are reviewed for conflicts of interest with public and academic roles.